

Method:

For this problem I used the hint to come up with a greedy algorithm that makes sure each index satisfies the condition as it goes. This is a classic greedy approach because it makes the best decision for each pair, and doesn't have to return to any previously checked pairs to ensure correctness of the end result.

Approach:

The program loops through the indices and then for each even index it compares index i and $i+1$, swapping if i is greater (all even indices should be less than the following index). Similarly for the odd indices it compares i and $i+1$ and swaps if $i+1$ is greater (all odd indices should be greater than the following index).

Reasoning:

This algorithm is efficient because it allows for the whole array to be sorted into the pattern in linear time. The loop is $O(n)$ and all of the comparison and swapping is $O(1)$.

Reflection:

I used these test cases:

Example 1:

Input: `nums = [3,5,2,1,6,4]`

Output: `[3,5,1,6,2,4]`

Explanation: `[1,6,2,5,3,4]` is also accepted.

Example 2:

Input: `nums = [6,6,5,6,3,8]`

Output: `[6,6,5,6,3,8]`

Time Complexity:

$O(n)$